



# RetailMart

## Daily Revenue Pipeline

End-to-End Airflow Project from Scratch

The hands-on project that makes Backfill · Catchup · Versioning · Promotion real

Astronomer Astro CLI

SQLite Local DB

Python Operators

No External APIs

# Why You Need This Project First

The four Airflow operations — backfill, catchup, versioning, and environment promotion — are **meaningless without a real pipeline to practise on**. You cannot backfill a DAG that never ran. You cannot observe catchup behaviour if there is no historical gap. You cannot version a DAG with no logic to change. This project gives you exactly that foundation.

| Operation  | What This Project Makes You Do                                               |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Backfill   | Revenue data from Jan 2026 was never loaded. Run backfill to fill the gap.   |
| Catchup    | Re-enable a paused DAG and watch 30 past intervals auto-schedule.            |
| Versioning | A new discount column is added in v2. Migrate live without breaking history. |
| Promotion  | Deploy dev→stage→prod using Astro GitHub Actions with the same DAG.          |

★ **IMPORTANT**

Complete this project first. Then every command in the Advanced Operations guide will have a real DAG and real data to operate on.

Overview & Architecture

What we are building, why, and how all the pieces connect

### 1.1 The Business Problem

**RetailMart** is a fictional e-commerce company selling products across three categories: Electronics, Clothing, and Groceries. Every day, a transactional database records every order. The analytics team needs a **daily revenue summary** loaded into a reporting table by 6 AM so that the morning dashboard is fresh for the business review.

The pipeline was launched on **1 May 2026** but the business later discovered that **January–April 2026 data existed in the source system and was never loaded**. This creates the perfect backfill scenario.

### 1.2 What the Pipeline Does (DAG Logic)

| # | Task ID         | Operator | What It Does                                                 |
|---|-----------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | generate_orders | Python   | Simulates raw order CSV for the data interval date.          |
| 2 | validate_orders | Python   | Checks for nulls, negative amounts, unknown categories.      |
| 3 | load_to_staging | Python   | Inserts raw rows into SQLite staging table.                  |
| 4 | compute_revenue | Python   | Aggregates revenue by category for the day.                  |
| 5 | load_to_report  | Python   | Upserts daily summary into the reporting table (idempotent). |
| 6 | audit_log       | Python   | Writes a run audit record (dag_id, date, row count, status). |

### 1.3 Why Each Task Was Chosen

Every task was designed to demonstrate a specific Airflow principle:

- generate\_orders uses context['data\_interval\_start']**  
Forces the task to generate data for the correct historical date during backfill — not today.
- load\_to\_report uses INSERT OR REPLACE**  
Makes the task idempotent: re-running the same date produces no duplicates.
- audit\_log records dag\_id + version**  
When you introduce v2, the audit table shows exactly which version ran each date.

**validate\_orders can fail intentionally**

Inject bad data for a date to practise --rerun-failed-tasks backfill.

# Setup from Zero

Initialise the Astro project, folder structure, and all supporting files

## Step 1 — Initialise the Astro Project

If you already have an active Astro deployment you can work locally and push, or connect directly. These commands create the project skeleton.

```
# Create a new directory for the project
mkdir retailmart-pipeline && cd retailmart-pipeline
# Initialise an Astronomer Astro project
astro dev init
# This generates the standard Astro scaffold:
# .astro/
# dags/
# include/
# plugins/
# tests/
# Dockerfile
# packages.txt
# requirements.txt
# .gitignore
# Start the local Airflow environment
astro dev start
# Confirm Airflow UI is up at http://localhost:8080
# Default login: admin / admin
```

## Step 2 — Install Dependencies

Add required packages to requirements.txt:

```
# requirements.txt (Astro Runtime already includes apache-airflow)
pandas==2.2.2
faker==25.0.0
```

### ■ NOTE

After editing requirements.txt, restart the local environment: `astro dev restart`

## Step 3 — Final Folder Structure

Create the files listed below. All paths are relative to the project root.

```
retailmart-pipeline/
├── dags/
│   ├── retailmart_revenue_v1.py # Main DAG – version 1
│   ├── retailmart_revenue_v2.py # Upgraded DAG – version 2 (added later)
│   ├── catchup_compare/
│   └── catchup_true_demo.py # Catchup demo DAG A
```

```
■ ■■■ catchup_false_demo.py # Catchup demo DAG B
■■■ include/
■ ■■■ db_utils.py # SQLite helpers (shared across DAG versions)
■ ■■■ data_gen.py # Order data generator
■■■ tests/
■ ■■■ test_retailmart_dag.py # Pytest DAG integrity tests
■■■ .github/
■ ■■■ workflows/
■ ■■■ astro_deploy.yml # CI/CD pipeline
■■■ requirements.txt
■■■ Dockerfile
```

# Source Files

Every file you need, fully commented, copy-paste ready

## File 1 — include/db\_utils.py

Shared SQLite helper used by every task in both v1 and v2. Using SQLite means **zero external database setup** — the DB lives inside the container at /tmp/retailmart.db.

```
# include/db_utils.py
"""
db_utils.py — SQLite database helpers for RetailMart pipeline.
All tables are created idempotently (CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS).
"""
import sqlite3, os
DB_PATH = os.environ.get('RETAILMART_DB', '/tmp/retailmart.db')

def get_conn():
    """Return a SQLite connection; creates the DB file if absent."""
    return sqlite3.connect(DB_PATH)

def init_db():
    """Create all tables. Safe to call on every DAG run (idempotent)."""
    conn = get_conn()
    cur = conn.cursor()

    # Raw orders — staging table
    cur.execute('''
        CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS raw_orders (
            order_id    TEXT PRIMARY KEY,
            order_date  TEXT NOT NULL,
            category    TEXT NOT NULL,
            amount      REAL NOT NULL,
            customer_id TEXT NOT NULL
        )
    ''')

    # Daily revenue report table (v1 schema)
    cur.execute('''
        CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS daily_revenue (
            report_date TEXT NOT NULL,
            category    TEXT NOT NULL,
            total_rev   REAL NOT NULL,
            order_count INTEGER NOT NULL,
            dag_version TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'v1',
            loaded_at   TEXT NOT NULL,
            PRIMARY KEY (report_date, category)
        )
    ''')

    # Audit log — one row per DAG run
    cur.execute('''
        CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS pipeline_audit (
            run_id      TEXT PRIMARY KEY,
            dag_id      TEXT NOT NULL,
            dag_version TEXT NOT NULL,
```

```

        exec_date    TEXT NOT NULL,
        row_count    INTEGER NOT NULL,
        status       TEXT NOT NULL,
        logged_at    TEXT NOT NULL
    )
    '')
    conn.commit(); conn.close()
def drop_day(date_str: str):
    """
    Remove all rows for a given date from both staging and report tables.
    Called at the start of each run to ensure full idempotency.
    """
    conn = get_conn(); cur = conn.cursor()
    cur.execute('DELETE FROM raw_orders WHERE order_date = ?', (date_str,))
    cur.execute('DELETE FROM daily_revenue WHERE report_date = ?', (date_str,))
    conn.commit(); conn.close()

```

## File 2 — include/data\_gen.py

Generates synthetic order records for any given date. The same seed is used per date so backfill re-runs produce identical data.

```

# include/data_gen.py
"""
data_gen.py – Deterministic synthetic order generator.
Same date + same seed = same orders every time (safe for backfill).
"""
import random, uuid
from datetime import date

CATEGORIES = ['Electronics', 'Clothing', 'Groceries']
PRICE_RANGE = {
    'Electronics': (500, 15000),
    'Clothing': (200, 3000),
    'Groceries': (50, 800),
}

def generate_orders(for_date: date, n_orders: int = 120) -> list[dict]:
    """
    Return a list of order dicts for for_date.
    Seed = YYYYMMDD integer – deterministic across backfills.
    """
    seed = int(for_date.strftime('%Y%m%d'))
    rng = random.Random(seed)
    orders = []
    for _ in range(n_orders):
        cat = rng.choice(CATEGORIES)
        lo, hi = PRICE_RANGE[cat]
        orders.append({
            'order_id': str(uuid.UUID(int=rng.getrandbits(128))),
            'order_date': for_date.isoformat(),
            'category': cat,
            'amount': round(rng.uniform(lo, hi), 2),
            'customer_id': f'CUST{rng.randint(1000, 9999)}',

```



```
} )  
return orders
```



```

context['ti'].xcom_push(key='orders', value=orders)
context['ti'].xcom_push(key='run_date', value=str(run_date))
print(f'[generate] {len(orders)} orders pushed to XCom')

def task_validate_orders(**context):
    """
    Validate order quality. Raises ValueError on bad data.
    You can inject failure here to practise --rerun-failed-tasks.
    """
    orders = context['ti'].xcom_pull(task_ids='generate_orders', key='orders')
    errors = []
    for o in orders:
        if o['amount'] <= 0:
            errors.append(f"order {o['order_id']}: non-positive amount")
        if o['category'] not in ('Electronics', 'Clothing', 'Groceries'):
            errors.append(f"order {o['order_id']}: unknown category")
        if not o['customer_id']:
            errors.append(f"order {o['order_id']}: missing customer_id")
    if errors:
        raise ValueError(f'Validation failed:\n' + '\n'.join(errors))
    print(f'[validate] All {len(orders)} orders passed validation')

def task_load_to_staging(**context):
    """
    Load validated orders into raw_orders staging table.
    Drops the day first – idempotent (safe to re-run).
    """
    ti = context['ti']
    orders = ti.xcom_pull(task_ids='generate_orders', key='orders')
    run_date = ti.xcom_pull(task_ids='generate_orders', key='run_date')
    # IDEMPOTENCY: delete existing rows for this date before inserting
    drop_day(run_date)
    print(f'[staging] Cleared existing rows for {run_date}')
    conn = get_conn()
    conn.executemany(
        'INSERT INTO raw_orders VALUES (:order_id,:order_date,:category,:amount,:customer_id)',
        orders,
    )
    conn.commit(); conn.close()
    print(f'[staging] Inserted {len(orders)} rows into raw_orders')

def task_compute_revenue(**context):
    """Aggregate revenue by category from staging table."""
    run_date = context['ti'].xcom_pull(task_ids='generate_orders', key='run_date')
    conn = get_conn(); cur = conn.cursor()
    cur.execute('''
        SELECT category,
               ROUND(SUM(amount), 2) AS total_rev,
               COUNT(*) AS order_count
        FROM raw_orders
        WHERE order_date = ?
        GROUP BY category
    ''', (run_date,))
    rows = cur.fetchall(); conn.close()
    revenue = [{'category': r[0], 'total_rev': r[1], 'order_count': r[2]}

```

```

        for r in rows]
        context['ti'].xcom_push(key='revenue', value=revenue)
        print(f'[compute] Revenue computed for {run_date}: {revenue}')

def task_load_to_report(**context):
    """
    Upsert daily revenue into daily_revenue reporting table.
    INSERT OR REPLACE ensures idempotency – same date can be loaded many times.
    """
    ti = context['ti']
    run_date = ti.xcom_pull(task_ids='generate_orders', key='run_date')
    revenue = ti.xcom_pull(task_ids='compute_revenue', key='revenue')
    now = datetime.utcnow().isoformat()
    conn = get_conn()
    for r in revenue:
        conn.execute('''
            INSERT OR REPLACE INTO daily_revenue
                (report_date, category, total_rev, order_count, dag_version, loaded_at)
            VALUES (?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?)
            ''', (run_date, r['category'], r['total_rev'],
                r['order_count'], DAG_VERSION, now))
    conn.commit(); conn.close()
    print(f'[report] {len(revenue)} category rows loaded for {run_date} [{DAG_VERSION}]')

def task_audit_log(**context):
    """Write a run audit record for observability."""
    ti = context['ti']
    run_date = ti.xcom_pull(task_ids='generate_orders', key='run_date')
    revenue = ti.xcom_pull(task_ids='compute_revenue', key='revenue')
    total_rows = sum(r['order_count'] for r in revenue)
    conn = get_conn()
    conn.execute('''
        INSERT OR REPLACE INTO pipeline_audit
            (run_id, dag_id, dag_version, exec_date, row_count, status, logged_at)
        VALUES (?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?)
        ''', (context['run_id'], context['dag'].dag_id, DAG_VERSION,
            run_date, total_rows, 'success', datetime.utcnow().isoformat()))
    conn.commit(); conn.close()
    print(f'[audit] Run {context["run_id"]} logged: {total_rows} orders')

# =====
# DAG DEFINITION
# start_date = 2026-01-01 intentionally – backfill gap exists from here.
# catchup = False initially – you will change this in the lab.
# =====

with DAG(
    dag_id='retailmart_revenue_v1',
    description='Daily revenue pipeline for RetailMart – Version 1',
    start_date=datetime(2026, 1, 1),
    schedule_interval='@daily',
    catchup=False, # LAB EXERCISE: change to True and observe
    max_active_runs=3, # Limits parallel backfill concurrency
    default_args={
        'owner': 'data-team',
        'retries': 2,
        'retry_delay': timedelta(minutes=3),
    },

```

```

        'email_on_failure': False,
    },
    tags=['retailmart', 'etl', 'revenue', DAG_VERSION],
    doc_md=''
)

### RetailMart Daily Revenue Pipeline v1
Generates synthetic orders, validates, stages, aggregates,
and loads daily revenue summaries into SQLite.
Safe for backfill – all tasks are idempotent.
'''
) as dag:
    t1 = PythonOperator(task_id='generate_orders', python_callable=task_generate_orders, provide_context=True)
    t2 = PythonOperator(task_id='validate_orders', python_callable=task_validate_orders, provide_context=True)
    t3 = PythonOperator(task_id='load_to_staging', python_callable=task_load_to_staging, provide_context=True)
    t4 = PythonOperator(task_id='compute_revenue', python_callable=task_compute_revenue, provide_context=True)
    t5 = PythonOperator(task_id='load_to_report', python_callable=task_load_to_report, provide_context=True)
    t6 = PythonOperator(task_id='audit_log', python_callable=task_audit_log, provide_context=True)

    t1 >> t2 >> t3 >> t4 >> t5 >> t6

```

## File 4 — dags/retailmart\_revenue\_v2.py (Versioned Upgrade)

Version 2 adds a **discount column** to the revenue report and renames a task. This is the file you deploy to demonstrate DAG versioning — v1 keeps running for historical dates while v2 handles dates from May 2026 onward.

```
# dags/retailmart_revenue_v2.py
"""
retailmart_revenue_v2.py
RetailMart Daily Revenue Pipeline – Version 2
Changes from v1:
- Added discount_total column to daily_revenue (schema migration task)
- Task 'load_to_staging' renamed to 'ingest_to_staging' (shows version break)
- start_date = 2026-05-01 (takes over from v1 which ends 2026-04-30)
"""
import sys
sys.path.insert(0, '/usr/local/airflow/include')
import sqlite3
from datetime import datetime, timedelta
from airflow import DAG
from airflow.operators.python import PythonOperator
from db_utils import init_db, drop_day, get_conn
from data_gen import generate_orders
DAG_VERSION = 'v2'

def task_migrate_schema(**context):
    """
    NEW in v2: Add discount_total column if it doesn't exist.
    Uses ALTER TABLE ... (SQLite ignores if column exists via try/except).
    """
    init_db()
    conn = get_conn()
    try:
        conn.execute('ALTER TABLE daily_revenue ADD COLUMN discount_total REAL DEFAULT 0.0')
        conn.commit()
        print('[migrate] Added discount_total column to daily_revenue')
    except Exception:
        print('[migrate] Column already exists – skipping')
    conn.close()

def task_generate_orders(**context):
    init_db()
    run_date = context['data_interval_start'].date()
    orders = generate_orders(for_date=run_date, n_orders=150) # v2: 150 orders/day
    context['ti'].xcom_push(key='orders', value=orders)
    context['ti'].xcom_push(key='run_date', value=str(run_date))
    print(f'[v2 generate] {len(orders)} orders for {run_date}')

def task_validate_orders(**context):
    orders = context['ti'].xcom_pull(task_ids='generate_orders', key='orders')
    bad = [o for o in orders if o['amount'] <= 0 or not o['category']]
    if bad:
        raise ValueError(f'{len(bad)} invalid orders detected')
    print(f'[v2 validate] {len(orders)} orders valid')

def task_ingest_to_staging(**context): # RENAMED from load_to_staging in v1
```

```

ti      = context['ti']
orders  = ti.xcom_pull(task_ids='generate_orders', key='orders')
run_date = ti.xcom_pull(task_ids='generate_orders', key='run_date')
drop_day(run_date)
conn = get_conn()
conn.executemany(
    'INSERT INTO raw_orders VALUES (:order_id,:order_date,:category,:amount,:customer_id
)',
    orders,
)
conn.commit(); conn.close()
print(f'[v2 ingest] {len(orders)} rows staged')

def task_compute_revenue(**context):
    run_date = context['ti'].xcom_pull(task_ids='generate_orders', key='run_date')
    conn = get_conn(); cur = conn.cursor()
    cur.execute('''
        SELECT category,
               ROUND(SUM(amount), 2)          AS total_rev,
               COUNT(*)                      AS order_count,
               ROUND(SUM(amount) * 0.05, 2) AS discount_total
        FROM raw_orders WHERE order_date = ?
        GROUP BY category
    ''', (run_date,))
    rows = cur.fetchall(); conn.close()
    revenue = [{'category': r[0], 'total_rev': r[1],
                'order_count': r[2], 'discount_total': r[3]} for r in rows]
    context['ti'].xcom_push(key='revenue', value=revenue)
    print(f'[v2 compute] {revenue}')

def task_load_to_report(**context):
    ti      = context['ti']
    run_date = ti.xcom_pull(task_ids='generate_orders', key='run_date')
    revenue  = ti.xcom_pull(task_ids='compute_revenue', key='revenue')
    now      = datetime.utcnow().isoformat()
    conn = get_conn()
    for r in revenue:
        conn.execute('''
            INSERT OR REPLACE INTO daily_revenue
            (report_date, category, total_rev, order_count,
             discount_total, dag_version, loaded_at)
            VALUES (?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?)
        ''', (run_date, r['category'], r['total_rev'],
              r['order_count'], r.get('discount_total', 0.0),
              DAG_VERSION, now))
    conn.commit(); conn.close()
    print(f'[v2 report] {len(revenue)} rows loaded [{DAG_VERSION}]')

def task_audit_log(**context):
    ti      = context['ti']
    run_date = ti.xcom_pull(task_ids='generate_orders', key='run_date')
    revenue  = ti.xcom_pull(task_ids='compute_revenue', key='revenue')
    total_rows = sum(r['order_count'] for r in revenue)
    conn = get_conn()
    conn.execute('''
        INSERT OR REPLACE INTO pipeline_audit
    ''')

```

```

        (run_id, dag_id, dag_version, exec_date, row_count, status, logged_at)
VALUES (?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?, ?)
'', (context['run_id'], context['dag'].dag_id, DAG_VERSION,
    run_date, total_rows, 'success', datetime.utcnow().isoformat()))
conn.commit(); conn.close()
with DAG(
    dag_id='retailmart-revenue_v2',
    description='Daily revenue pipeline – Version 2 (adds discount_total)',
    start_date=datetime(2026, 5, 1),    # Takes over from v1
    schedule_interval='@daily',
    catchup=False,
    max_active_runs=3,
    default_args={
        'owner': 'data-team',
        'retries': 2,
        'retry_delay': timedelta(minutes=3),
        'email_on_failure': False,
    },
    tags=['retailmart', 'etl', 'revenue', DAG_VERSION],
) as dag:
    t0 = PythonOperator(task_id='migrate_schema',    python_callable=task_migrate_schema,
                        provide_context=True)
    t1 = PythonOperator(task_id='generate_orders',    python_callable=task_generate_orders,
                        provide_context=True)
    t2 = PythonOperator(task_id='validate_orders',    python_callable=task_validate_orders,
                        provide_context=True)
    t3 = PythonOperator(task_id='ingest_to_staging',    python_callable=task_ingest_to_staging,
                        provide_context=True)
    t4 = PythonOperator(task_id='compute_revenue',    python_callable=task_compute_revenue,
                        provide_context=True)
    t5 = PythonOperator(task_id='load_to_report',    python_callable=task_load_to_report,
                        provide_context=True)
    t6 = PythonOperator(task_id='audit_log',    python_callable=task_audit_log,
                        provide_context=True)
    t0 >> t1 >> t2 >> t3 >> t4 >> t5 >> t6

```



## File 5 — dags/catchup\_compare/catchup\_true\_demo.py

A lightweight DAG with catchup=True. When enabled for the first time alongside catchup\_false\_demo, the Grid view contrast is immediately visible.

```
# dags/catchup_compare/catchup_true_demo.py
from airflow import DAG
from airflow.operators.python import PythonOperator
from datetime import datetime

with DAG(
    dag_id='catchup_true_demo',
    start_date=datetime(2026, 4, 1),    # 40 days ago
    schedule_interval='@daily',
    catchup=True,                      # Creates ~40 runs on first enable
    max_active_runs=5,
    tags=['demo', 'catchup', 'compare'],
) as dag:
    def show_interval(**ctx):
        start = ctx['data_interval_start']
        end = ctx['data_interval_end']
        print(f'[catchup=True] interval: {start.date()} -> {end.date()}')

    PythonOperator(
        task_id='show_interval',
        python_callable=show_interval,
        provide_context=True,
    )
```

## File 6 — dags/catchup\_compare/catchup\_false\_demo.py

```
# dags/catchup_compare/catchup_false_demo.py
from airflow import DAG
from airflow.operators.python import PythonOperator
from datetime import datetime

with DAG(
    dag_id='catchup_false_demo',
    start_date=datetime(2026, 4, 1),    # Same start_date as above
    schedule_interval='@daily',
    catchup=False,                     # Only 1 run created on enable
    tags=['demo', 'catchup', 'compare'],
) as dag:
    def show_interval(**ctx):
        start = ctx['data_interval_start']
        end = ctx['data_interval_end']
        print(f'[catchup=False] interval: {start.date()} -> {end.date()}')

    PythonOperator(
        task_id='show_interval',
        python_callable=show_interval,
        provide_context=True,
    )
```

## File 7 — tests/test\_retailmart\_dag.py

Pytest tests that validate the DAG loads correctly, has no import errors, and the task dependency chain is intact. These run in CI before every deploy.

```
# tests/test_retailmart_dag.py
"""
DAG integrity tests – run with: astro dev pytest tests/
or locally: pytest tests/ -v
"""
import pytest
from airflow.models import DagBag

DAG_BAG = DagBag(dag_folder='dags/', include_examples=False)

def test_no_import_errors():
    """No DAG file should have import errors."""
    assert DAG_BAG.import_errors == {}, \
        f'Import errors: {DAG_BAG.import_errors}'

def test_v1_dag_exists():
    assert 'retailmart_revenue_v1' in DAG_BAG.dags

def test_v1_task_count():
    dag = DAG_BAG.dags['retailmart_revenue_v1']
    assert len(dag.tasks) == 6, f'Expected 6 tasks, got {len(dag.tasks)}'

def test_v1_task_order():
    dag = DAG_BAG.dags['retailmart_revenue_v1']
    task_ids = [t.task_id for t in dag.topological_sort()]
    expected = ['generate_orders', 'validate_orders', 'load_to_staging',
                'compute_revenue', 'load_to_report', 'audit_log']
    assert task_ids == expected, f'Order mismatch: {task_ids}'

def test_v1_catchup_is_false():
    """Default should be catchup=False to prevent accidental mass scheduling."""
    dag = DAG_BAG.dags['retailmart_revenue_v1']
    assert dag.catchup is False

def test_v2_dag_exists():
    """v2 should exist once retailmart_revenue_v2.py is added."""
    if 'retailmart_revenue_v2' in DAG_BAG.dags:
        dag = DAG_BAG.dags['retailmart_revenue_v2']
        assert len(dag.tasks) == 7, 'v2 should have 7 tasks (including migrate_schema)'

def test_catchup_demos_exist():
    for dag_id in ('catchup_true_demo', 'catchup_false_demo'):
        assert dag_id in DAG_BAG.dags, f'{dag_id} not found'
```

# Step Lab Exercises

Run each lab in order — each one uses the DAG you just built

## Lab 1 — Execute Backfill (Jan–Apr 2026 Missing Data)

RetailMart's pipeline started on May 1 2026. The analytics team has now discovered that order data exists in the source system from January 2026. You need to backfill four months of revenue data.

1

### Confirm v1 DAG is enabled (catchup=False)

Open <http://localhost:8080>, find `retailmart_revenue_v1`, confirm it is ON. The Grid should show only recent runs (if any).

2

### Run a dry-run to preview intervals

This shows which `logical_dates` would be created without actually running.

3

### Execute the backfill for Jan–Apr 2026

This triggers 120 DAG runs (31+28+31+30 days). `max_active_runs=3` limits concurrency.

4

### Monitor progress in the Airflow UI

Grid view: watch the green squares fill in left-to-right. Each column is one day, each row is one task.

5

### Verify data in SQLite

Connect to the container and query the reporting table to confirm all dates loaded.

```
# Step 2 – Dry run
astro dev run dags backfill \
  -s 2026-01-01 -e 2026-05-01 \
  --dry-run \
  retailmart_revenue_v1

# Step 3 – Actual backfill
astro dev run dags backfill \
  -s 2026-01-01 \
  -e 2026-05-01 \
  retailmart_revenue_v1

# Step 5 – Verify in SQLite
astro dev bash # Opens a shell inside the Airflow container
# Inside the container:
sqlite3 /tmp/retailmart.db
# SQLite queries to verify:
.mode column
.headers on
-- Check how many dates were loaded
```

```
SELECT COUNT(DISTINCT report_date) AS loaded_days FROM daily_revenue;
-- Expected: 120
-- Sample the first 5 dates
SELECT * FROM daily_revenue ORDER BY report_date LIMIT 15;
-- Audit log confirms backfill run IDs
SELECT dag_version, exec_date, row_count
FROM pipeline_audit
ORDER BY exec_date LIMIT 10;
.quit
```

#### ✓ PRO TIP

Notice that `run_id` in `pipeline_audit` starts with `backfill__2026-01-01...` rather than `scheduled__`. This is how Airflow marks backfill-triggered runs.

## Lab 2 — Compare Catchup Behaviour

Enable the two catchup demo DAGs at exactly the same moment and observe how differently Airflow handles the same 40-day gap.

1

### Ensure both demo DAGs are present and PAUSED

In the UI, confirm `catchup_true_demo` and `catchup_false_demo` are visible and paused.

2

### Enable BOTH at the same time

Toggle ON `catchup_true_demo` first, immediately toggle ON `catchup_false_demo`. Refresh the Grid view within 10 seconds.

3

### Observe the Grid view difference

`catchup_true_demo`: ~40 queued runs filling the entire historical grid. `catchup_false_demo`: only 1 run for today.

4

### Change v1 to catchup=True and restart

Edit `retailmart_revenue_v1.py`, change `catchup=False` to `catchup=True`, save. Restart `astro dev restart`. Pause then unpause the DAG — observe mass scheduling.

5

### Revert to catchup=False

Change back to `catchup=False` and restart. This is the safe production default.

```
# Edit v1 to flip catchup (Step 4)
# In retailmart_revenue_v1.py, change:
#   catchup=False
# to:
#   catchup=True
# Restart the environment to pick up the change
```

```
astro dev restart
# Pause the DAG (so it doesn't auto-run), then unpause
astro dev run dags pause    retailmart_revenue_v1
astro dev run dags unpause retailmart_revenue_v1
# Watch runs flood in – then immediately pause again to stop them
astro dev run dags pause retailmart_revenue_v1
# Count how many runs were triggered
astro dev run dags list-runs -d retailmart_revenue_v1 | wc -l
```

## Lab 3 — Implement DAG Versioning (v1 → v2)

The business wants a `discount_total` column in the revenue report from May 2026 onward. You will deploy v2 without touching v1's historical data.

1

### Set v1 `end_date` to 2026-04-30

Open `retailmart_revenue_v1.py`, add `end_date=datetime(2026, 4, 30)` to the DAG. This stops v1 from creating any new runs after April.

2

### Place `retailmart_revenue_v2.py` in `dags/`

The file already uses `start_date=datetime(2026, 5, 1)`. Astro will auto-detect it within 30 seconds.

3

### Confirm both DAGs are visible in the UI

You should see `retailmart_revenue_v1` (historical) and `retailmart_revenue_v2` (current). v1 shows no new runs scheduled. v2 shows today's run.

4

### Trigger v2 manually for 2026-05-01

Click Trigger DAG in the UI, set `logical_date` to 2026-05-01. After success, check the `daily_revenue` table — the new row should have `dag_version=v2`.

5

### Query audit log to see both versions

The `pipeline_audit` table will show v1 rows for Jan–Apr and v2 rows for May onward.

```
# Step 1 – add end_date to v1 (inside the DAG() block):
#   end_date=datetime(2026, 4, 30),

# Step 4 – verify the schema migration happened
astro dev bash
sqlite3 /tmp/retailmart.db
-- Check columns in daily_revenue
PRAGMA table_info(daily_revenue);
-- Should show discount_total column added by migrate_schema task
-- Compare v1 vs v2 rows
SELECT dag_version, MIN(report_date), MAX(report_date), COUNT(*)
FROM daily_revenue
GROUP BY dag_version;
```

```
-- audit log cross-version view
SELECT dag_version, exec_date, row_count
FROM pipeline_audit
ORDER BY exec_date DESC LIMIT 10;
```

## Lab 4 — Promote DAG Across Environments

Push retailmart\_revenue\_v2.py through the Dev → Stage → Production pipeline using the GitHub Actions workflow and your active Astro deployment.

1

### Initialise Git repo and push to GitHub

Commit all project files to a GitHub repository. Create branches: develop, staging, and main.

2

### Add GitHub secrets for Astro tokens

In GitHub repo Settings > Secrets: add ASTRONOMER\_KEY\_ID, ASTRONOMER\_KEY\_SECRET, and your DEV/STG/PRD deployment IDs.

3

### Push to develop → triggers Dev deploy

git checkout develop && git push. GitHub Actions runs pytest then deploys to Dev deployment automatically.

4

### Open PR: develop → staging

Create a PR and get it reviewed. Merge triggers Stage deploy with 1 approval gate.

5

### Tag a release → triggers Production deploy

git tag v2.0.0 && git push origin v2.0.0. Production job pauses for 2 reviewer approvals before executing.

```
# Step 1 – initialise git
cd retailmart-pipeline
git init
git remote add origin https://github.com/<your-org>/retailmart-pipeline.git
git checkout -b develop
git add .
git commit -m 'feat: retailmart revenue pipeline v1 + v2'
git push -u origin develop

# Step 3 – watch CI run
#   GitHub Actions tab > workflow run > pytest logs should show 7 tests passed

# Step 5 – tag for production
git checkout main
git merge staging
git tag -a v2.0.0 -m 'retailmart_revenue_v2: discount_total column'
git push origin v2.0.0

# Verify the deploy reached Astro
astro deployment inspect $PRD_DEPLOYMENT_ID
```

```
astro deployment logs $PRD_DEPLOYMENT_ID --scheduler | tail -20
```

on Queries & Expected Outputs

Use these SQLite queries to confirm each lab completed correctly

| Lab Check                       | Query / Action                                                           | Expected Result                                      |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Lab 1 — Backfill complete       | SELECT COUNT(DISTINCT report_date)<br>FROM daily_revenue;                | 120 (one per day Jan–Apr 2026)                       |
| Lab 1 — All 3 categories loaded | SELECT category, COUNT(*) FROM<br>daily_revenue GROUP BY category;       | Electronics / Clothing / Groceries,<br>each 120 rows |
| Lab 1 — Backfill run IDs        | SELECT run_id FROM pipeline_audit LIMIT 3;                               | backfill__2026-01-01T00:00:00+00:00                  |
| Lab 2 — Catchup run count       | SELECT COUNT(*) FROM pipeline_audit<br>WHERE dag_id='catchup_true_demo'; | ~40 rows                                             |
| Lab 3 — Both versions present   | SELECT DISTINCT dag_version FROM<br>daily_revenue;                       | v1, v2                                               |
| Lab 3 — Schema migration        | PRAGMA table_info(daily_revenue);                                        | discount_total column visible                        |
| Lab 4 — v2 in Production        | Astro UI > Deployment > DAGs tab                                         | retailmart_revenue_v2 listed and<br>active           |

✓ PRO TIP

If any query returns unexpected results, re-check that `data_interval_start` is used (not `datetime.now()`), and that `drop_day()` runs before inserts in `load_to_staging`. These two patterns are the foundation of all backfill safety.

Common Errors & Fixes

| Error                                        | Fix                                                                                                             |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ModuleNotFoundError: db_utils                | <code>sys.path.insert(0, '/usr/local/airflow/include')</code> missing at top of DAG file.                       |
| sqlite3.OperationalError: no such table      | <code>init_db()</code> not called in <code>generate_orders</code> task. Ensure it is the first call.            |
| XCom key 'orders' returned None              | Task ID mismatch in <code>xcom_pull</code> — check <code>task_ids</code> parameter matches exactly.             |
| Backfill creates 0 runs                      | <code>start_date</code> is in the future, or the date range is outside <code>start_date/end_date</code> window. |
| Duplicate rows in <code>daily_revenue</code> | Not using <code>INSERT OR REPLACE</code> — check <code>load_to_report</code> task SQL.                          |
| v2 tasks not visible in UI                   | File not saved to <code>dags/</code> or Airflow hasn't refreshed. Wait 30s or restart dev env.                  |